
Paper 3, Option 37.1:

The changing nature of warfare, 1859–1991: perception and reality

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore cultural and socio-political developments in how warfare has been perceived in the USA and also some of the developments in the nature of warfare internationally, in terms of evolving technology and the ability of military leaders to utilise or counter it. These technological changes would transform the ability of states to wage war and affect the course of conflicts around the globe.

Aspects in breadth: war and the American public mind, 1859–1991	
Themes	Content
1 Reporting and portraying war	- Changes in the reporting of war and the impact of new technologies, 1859–1991: the telegraph, photography, film, radio, television, satellite communication (key developments: the reporting of the US Civil War, Spanish-American War and the First World War, filming the Second World War, the televised reporting in Vietnam and in particular the Tet Offensive 1968, instantaneous reporting from the First Gulf War). - The changing remembrance and portrayal of war, 1859–1991 in ceremonies, novels, plays, war books and comics, films and television series (key developments: the impact of the film <i>All Quiet on the Western Front</i> 1930, the portrayal in Hollywood films of the Second World War in 1940s and 1950s and Vietnam War in the 1970s and 1980s).
2 Attempts to influence the public response to war	- Official attempts to shape the public perception of wars, 1859–1991: the use of speeches, briefings, propaganda and information control in the US Civil War, Spanish-American War, the First and Second World Wars, the Vietnam War and the First Gulf War (key developments the Gettysburg Address 1863, demonising the enemy in the First World War 1917–18, Roosevelt's broadcast after Pearl Harbor 1941). - The impact of propaganda and news control, 1859–1991 (key developments: the hostility to conscription in the US Civil War, the wave of anti-German sentiment 1917–18, the contrasting success of US governments with the media during the Vietnam and First Gulf War).

Aspects in depth: new technology and its use by military leaders	
Key topics	Content
1 Increased firepower and steam power, 1859–70	• The use of railways and steam boats to move and supply armies: the mobilisation of French and Austrian armies in 1859 and problems encountered in the initial deployment. • Increased firepower: Colt's revolver, breechloading rifles, Krupp's artillery; the breechloader vs. muzzle-loader debate. • Von Moltke and the Prussian general staff and their influence on military planning; the Prussian use of the new technologies in the wars of 1866 and 1870, and Grant's use of them in US Civil War, 1863–65.
2 Technology of defence: machine guns, smokeless powder and artillery, c1900–16	• The impact of the development of smokeless propellants and machine guns before 1914 on military thought and planning. • The impact of French 75mm and German heavies before 1914 on the French Plan XVII and the Schlieffen Plan. • The role of technology in a failure of a war of movement, Western Front 1914; the roles of Joffre and the younger Moltke. The use of these technologies in a war of attrition: Falkenhayn's assault on Verdun and Petain's defence 1916.
3 Radios, the internal combustion engine and mobile warfare, 1917–1940	• The impact of the internal combustion engine in tanks, aircraft and transport, 1917–18: the battles of Cambrai 1917 and Amiens 1918; the impact of radio in the First World War and its implications for the development of mobile warfare. • The impact of these new technologies on French planning in the 1930s and use under General Maurice Gamelin in 1940. • The impact of these new technologies on German planning in the 1930s; the role of Guderian as theorist of Blitzkrieg; the attack on France in 1940 and roles of Guderian and Rommel.
4 The war at sea, 1917–45: the impact of submarines, air power and complex codes	• The impact of submarines, 1917–18: initial German triumph; British counter-measures and eventual success. • The impact of submarines, 1939–45; Dönitz and the Battle of the Atlantic; the significance of May 1943 as a turning point. The importance of naval codes and associated technology: Enigma and counter measures. • The impact of airpower: Yamamoto and the planning of the attack on Pearl Harbour 1941; Yamamoto and Nagumo against Nimitz and Spruance at Midway 1942.
5 Air power and nuclear weapons, 1943–91	• The significance of developments in aerial warfare: bombs and counter-measures, jet engines, missiles and nuclear weapons; their influence on strategic planning. • The destructive impact of terror bombing, 1943–45: Harris' assault on Hamburg in 1943; Curtis LeMay's bombing campaign of Tokyo and Hiroshima in 1945.